

Readiness Assessment | 2025-2026

Please review the document below as Granted will be reviewing your CanExport project in a recorded interview. Feel free to input notes to help you during the interview.

Process Overview

- 1) Budget review, activities review
- 2) Creating an account in the portal
- 3) Writing
 - a) Connect and Overview for Trade Commissioner
- 4) Draft Creation
- 5) Review & Submission
- 6) Adjudication 60 days
- 7) Approval - start spending money!
- 8) Review Outcomes
- 9) Reporting
- 10) Complete Project

Target Market Identification

Have you selected a target market that accounts for the following? (during the last complete tax reporting year (or last 12 months for monthly and quarterly filers)

Less than \$100,000 in sales

-OR-

Less than 10% of international sales (including domestic and total International)

If your project includes multiple markets:

Each market must be less than 10% of your company's total company revenue

Have you already been approved for a CanExport? How much and when?

Does your target market have a free trade agreement?

Target Markets Review

Please advise: Entrance to the United States is mutually exclusive with other markets.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

For stronger applications, we suggest a maximum of two target markets per application.

Target Customer Review

B2B

Business size	
Established # of years	
Number of employees	
Industry	

B2C - End Consumer: Looking for any person over the age of 18

Age range	
Education	
Profession / location	
Preferences / needs	

Qualifiers

A.

1. Have you previously received funding from the CanExport SME program?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, please share when you received funding and how much was received.

If yes, please explain how the new project builds on or makes changes to the previous project.

2. Do you already have an existing office in the target market?

☐ Yes

☐ No

*If so, your target market is **ineligible** for the program, and you must pick a new one.*

3. Are you a trading house/distributor/export broker?

☐ Yes

☐ No

*If so, your company is **ineligible** for the program.*

4. Is your company woman-owned, operated or controlled?

☐ Yes

☐ No

5. Is your company indigenous-owned, operated or controlled?

☐ Yes

☐ No

6. Is your company youth-owned, operated or controlled? (under 39yo)

☐ Yes

☐ No

7. Is your company visible minority-owned, operated or controlled?

☐ Yes

☐ No

8. Is your company LGBTQ2+-owned, operated or controlled?

☐ Yes

☐ No

B.

1. *Is your product/service of Canadian origin*? If yes, explain. If not, what value is added in Canada? What percentage of the product or service is produced in Canada alone?*

**For tech or service-based companies, please provide a ratio of outsourced (non-Canadian) to local (Canadian) teams.*

2. *What is the primary rationale for entering your chosen target (e.g. logistics, market size/trends, etc.)? How do you feel the last project impacted your decision to enter the selected markets?*
a. *If US, please explain how your rationale is justified over the current and developing political economic climate (i.e. US tariffs)?*
b. *Are you confident that you can generate revenue in the US in this CanExport?*
3. *How are conditions in the target market favorable for entry of your product/service? Any changes to the conditions from the last application (if same market)?*
4. *What risks/challenges do you anticipate? (at least 3)*
5. *Do you have an updated business plan and/or market entrance strategy in place? (Yes/No/Partial) If yes, please provide a copy.*

• Yes

• No

• Partial

6. Which countries have you actively exported to? (for the U.S., China, India, Brazil – please identify the region)?
7. Are you currently in the process of entering any other new foreign markets?
8. Who will be working on this project (name, title of employee)? What will their role be (project manager, onboarding specialist, lead conversion, etc.)?
- a. CanExport is highly sensitive to any existing connections in the target market who would be considered an in-market representative. (Connections can be established by online platforms like LinkedIn. If your connection has anything related to your company on their social media, it is considered high risk.)
9. What is your company's annual budget range for international expansion activities? (Grant covers 50% of expenses up to \$50,000)
10. Have you been in contact with the Trade Commissioner Service or NRC IRAP Advisors responsible for your industry and/or in your target market(s)?
- a. It is ideal to initiate a connection before submission of application. The conversation with TCS does not need to have taken place, but the priority is to have this box ticked as 'Yes'.

☐ Yes

☐ No

11. Do you have an IP strategy for conducting business abroad? If yes, what is it? Have you sought consultation from any government bodies or external agencies? Are you trademarked?
- a. If no trademarking or registered IP protection exists, it should be included as an activity in the project budget. If there is no existing IP protection when applying, please explain why..

12. Competitors

Company Name	Presence in the Market	Your Competitive Advantage

Project Outcomes

<i>Expected revenue increase as a result of project by March 31, 2026?</i>	
<i>How many additional leads would you generate by March 31, 2026?</i>	
<i>How many jobs will this project help to create within your organization <u>in Canada</u>?</i>	
<i>How much additional investment in Canada would this project garner?</i>	
<i>Increased R&D/Innovation</i>	
<i>Agreements signed</i>	
<i>Other</i>	

Project Activities

Does your project include any of the following activities? (check applicable)

Marketing and Promotional Material

- ☐ Flyers, pamphlets, brochures
- ☐ Translation of marketing material

REMINDER: SEO and all online advertising are now ineligible for CanExport. (Some necessary advertorials for trade events can be accepted.)

Consultant Services

All consultants and contractors must not be internally affiliated with your organization in any way, and all transactions/activities must be completed at arm's distance. They must have a specific expertise not otherwise available within your company and cannot be an in-market representative or employee that is conducting business on your behalf.

All consultants must be based in Canada or one of the target markets unless otherwise justified. Additionally, if costs exceed \$10K, a statement of work that specifically indicates the target markets must be obtained from the program.

- ☐ Market research
- ☐ Sales consulting
- ☐ Other business advice
- ☐ Lead lists
- ☐ Legal advice and regulatory issues
 - ☐ Applying for local IP protection (trademark, patent, etc.)
 - ☐ Obtaining certification required for market access
 - ☐ Drafting and legal review/adaptation of contracts signed with local partners
- ☐ Tax advice
- ☐ General market advice and market access consulting

Trade shows

- ☐ Travel
- ☐ Registration and booth fees
- ☐ A/V equipment rentals

- ☐ Meeting room fees
- ☐ Shipping fees (booth materials, samples, prototypes)

Final Housekeeping

- **ONE OFF** \$6000 writing fee - 3000 upfront, 3000 before submission
- **CLIENT** \$3000 upfront writing fee, to be deducted from 20% success based fee
- Ensure Schedule B is signed
- You will need to sign up to the online portal and complete Part A of the application (eligibility check) <https://portal-portail.nrc-cnrc.gc.ca/en-CA/CanExport/canexport-sme/>
- Next step would be to prepare a budget and then we would have an interview phone call with you to gather project details to write the application.
- Once the project budget is confirmed we will help you connect with the Trade Commissioner to review the application.
- Timing of writeup is 7 to 10 business days for a Draft which will have some pieces of info you'll need to help fill in or verify during review
- All documents will be shared on Google Docs
- CanExport New Document Requirements, including articles of incorporation and GST return